

GROW BIO INTENSIVE COURSE

A bio-intensive agriculture course focuses on sustainable, small scale farming techniques to maximize yield and soil fertility without chemical inputs, usually covering double-digging, composting, intensive spacing, and carbon/calorie farming. Training typically includes both classroom theory and practical, hands on demonstrations.

Core Module Outline

- **Introduction to Bio-intensive Farming**
 - o Principles of sustainable agriculture o History, and
 - o The 8 core components (Composting, double digging, intensive planting, companion planting, carbon farming, calorie farming, open-pollinated seeds, and whole-system design).

Soil Fertility and Preparation

- o Double digging technique to break hardpans
- o Soil aeration, and creation of raised beds

Composting and Soil Nutrition

- o Techniques for making, managing, and applying compost to build long-term soil health using local materials.

Intensive Planting and Spacing

- o Planting in raised beds using hexagonal spacing to maximize yield per square meter,
- o Conserve water, and
- o Reduce weeds

Carbon and Calorie Farming

- o Dedicated planting for soil sustainability (60% for carbon/compost) and human nutrition (30% for calorie-dense crops)

Seed Production and Management

- o Saving open-pollinated seeds and selecting for vigor, yield, and adaptability

Companion Planting and Pest Management

- o Natural pest control using beneficial insects
- o Intercropping, and
- o Organic remedies

Farm Planning and Management

- o Developing planting calendars
- o Maintaining records, and
- o Scaling for family nutrition and income

Typical Training programs

- **Introductory:** 5-day workshops covering basics
- **Comprehensive:** 9-week or 9-Saturday intensive, hands –on courses
- **Methods:** Classroom lessons paired with on –farm, participatory demonstrations